

The moment people see environmental impacts with AI, everyone's suddenly an environmentalist

Posted by u/PolarGorilla120 • 0 points • 16 comments

Like before, no one really cared about environmental impacts of societal activities except actual environmentalists, but then all of a sudden when news outlets reported environmental impacts of data centers, people who previously didn't give a shit is now Greta Thunberg. If they really cared, they might as well drive less, eat less meat, and produce less waste which I suspect they don't.

Comments

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2026-01-01 08:50 UTC

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u/Traditional-Mood-44 • 2 points • 2025-12-31 19:01 UTC

Yep. It's just like all the people who suddenly care about birds when wind turbines are brought up.

u/RagingFeverDream • 1 points • 2025-12-31 00:40 UTC

Any problem AI has with the environment can easily be solved with waterless cooling centers and greener energy programs, like solar-powered fans, ETC. But they never bring that up because it would go against their hatred crusade against generative AI.

u/Specific_Candle_7341 • 1 points • 2025-12-31 01:23 UTC

So close

u/Chaghatai • 3 points • 2025-12-30 23:22 UTC

They also don't seem to understand that most data centers use non-potable water sources

They also refused to acknowledge that modern data centers—the newer ones—are recirculating their water

So in so much as new data centers are being built to feed AI's hunger for processing, that new capacity is being brought online with plants that recirculate their water

They also don't realize that the data centers discharge their water into non-potable streams. They are not polluting the water that people drink

The water is also not contaminated with pollutants—when you use it for cooling, you don't have to pump it with a bunch of chemicals like they do fracking fluid— just a little bit of hypochlorous acid or chlorine dioxide—the same kind of stuff they put in municipal water supplies and used for the same reason to keep bio scum from building up on their surfaces and clogging the works, and it is temporary in nature

u/E5641651 • 3 points • 2025-12-31 01:05 UTC

most of them dont even know the term "datacenter" before ai started back then, cuz if they do then they'd know that majority of the internet platforms are the ones using datacenters altogether currently, none of these monkeys really cares about the environment

u/MrWindblade • 4 points • 2025-12-30 23:02 UTC

I don't see the environmental impact being nearly as much of a threat as I do the shortcuts we take in factory farming and the pollution from major industrial operations.

Datacenters will someday become more efficient and potentially reach a low carbon footprint.

We can't say the same for industrial operations like cobalt mining.

u/DesertFroggo • 8 points • 2025-12-30 22:42 UTC

That's what I've been saying myself. Most of these anti-AI people don't truly give a shit about the environment in the abstract. It's just a convenient outlet for their hatred of AI. Before AI, they had little or nothing to say about lawns, golf courses, beef, bad insulation, inefficient appliances, or any of the many other things that waste water and energy. I doubt many of them could even tell you what a watt-hour is.

u/Dreaming_of_Rlyeh • 10 points • 2025-12-30 22:37 UTC

It's because they don't personally like AI art, so they're looking for justification other than "I don't like it" because that doesn't have enough weight.

u/PolarGorilla120 • 5 points • 2025-12-30 22:58 UTC

Yeah, they only care about the environment if it agrees with something they don't like.

u/TripleBenthusiast • 9 points • 2025-12-30 22:20 UTC

The craziest thing is that all generative AI in the world still uses less water than just TikTok's US servers. You bring this up and they backtrack. The datacenters could all be perfectly green it just costs more money. Once again it's not AI but a symptom of capitalism chasing profit margins.

u/Breech Loader • 3 points • 2025-12-30 23:27 UTC

Many of the water users in the USA could be a LOT more efficient in their water use, and STILL have the same output, but it would cost them like, tuppence in profit.

u/TripleBenthusiast • 1 points • 2025-12-30 23:34 UTC

Oh I know, that's what really pisses me off. At my job, we needed to find server cooling that doesn't use fresh water at all. The literal tons of ways they could have ZERO fresh water usage PMO so bad.

u/Konkichi21 • 2 points • 2025-12-30 22:54 UTC

Yeah, remember that things like resource consumption are just a part of everything else we use computers for, which is a lot.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-12-30 21:55 UTC

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u/atlasfrompaladins • 5 points • 2025-12-30 21:54 UTC

It's situational, plus if you tell them to do that extra stuff they're just gonna block you and move on.